Trouble at the Airport

present continuous · airport language

A2 · CEFR | 60 MIN | 4 FRONTS: INPUT · SHADOWING · TBLT · RECONFIGURATION

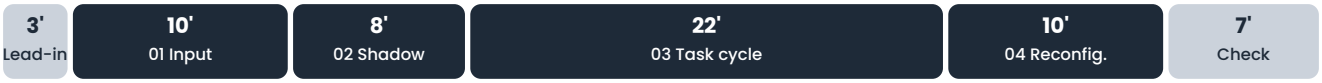
LEVEL	TIME	LANGUAGE FOCUS	FORMAT
A2	**60 minutes**	**present continuous · airport language**	**TBLT · 4 fronts**

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Main aim. By the end of the lesson, students can explain what is happening in a simple airport problem, using the present continuous.

- ☐ Use 8 airport chunks (boarding pass, check-in desk, gate) in context.
- ☐ Describe what people are doing now: She is looking for her bag.
- ☐ Ask for help politely: Can you help me, please?
- ☐ Place stress on the important words in short questions.

LESSON FLOW



MIN	STAGE	INTERACTION	WHAT HAPPENS	FRONT
3	**Lead-in**	Whole class	Activate the topic and the key words.	—
10	**Comprehensible Input**	Individual → pairs	Read and listen. Gist first, then true / false.	01
8	**Shadowing**	Whole class → pairs	Listen, mark stress, echo, shadow the model dialogue.	02
22	**Task cycle (TBLT)**	Pairs → groups	Pre-task → task → planning → report → language focus.	03
10	**Reconfiguration**	Individual → pairs	Rebuild sentences from meaning blocks; transform sentences.	04
7	**Check & close**	Individual	Exit ticket + can-do self-assessment.	

READ Read & understand

VOCABULARY Remember

PATTERN Notice the pattern

WATCH OUT Watch out!

01

FRONT 01 · COMPREHENSIBLE INPUT

Read and listen

A short, understandable text (i+1) that carries the target language.

PROFESSOR

Lead-in (3 min): mostre uma foto de aeroporto e pergunte 'What are people doing?'. Leitura: 1° contato só para o gist, 2° para os detalhes. Pré-ensine no máximo 3 palavras.

READ

Hi Marco,

Greetings from the airport! It's chaos here. I'm standing at gate 14 and my flight is boarding, but my bag isn't with me. A man at the check-in desk is helping me now. He is looking for my luggage on his computer.

My friend Lena is waiting for me at the cafe. She's drinking a coffee and she's laughing at me! The other passengers are walking to the plane with their boarding passes. I'm not walking anywhere. I'm waiting.

Oh, wait. The man is smiling and he's carrying my bag! Everything is fine. I'm running to the gate now!

Speak soon,
Ana

WORD BANK

gate
where you wait to get on the plane

check-in desk
the place to give your bag

boarding pass
paper or phone ticket for the plane

luggage
bags and suitcases

passenger
a person who travels

chaos
a very confusing situation

Highlights: yellow new words · green target verb forms · red irregular

A · GIST — CIRCLE

1. Where is Ana?
a) at home b) at the airport c) at school

2. What is the problem?
a) Her bag is missing. b) Her flight is cancelled.
c) Her phone is broken.

B · DETAIL — TRUE (T) OR FALSE (F)?

1. Lena is drinking a coffee. ___
2. Ana is walking to the plane. ___
3. A man is looking for the luggage. ___
4. The bag is lost forever. ___

02

FRONT 02 · SHADOWING

Listen, then speak with the model

Imitate rhythm, stress and intonation. This dialogue also models the task.

PROFESSOR

Protocolo: (1) ouvir sem ler, (2) marcar as palavras fortes em verde, (3) echo linha a linha, (4) shadowing em voz baixa. Este diálogo é o modelo do task da próxima página.

1	**Listen** no reading	2	**Mark** stress words	3	**Echo** line by line	4	**Shadow** speak together

MODEL DIALOGUE

ANA	**Excuse** me, I'm **looking** for my **bag.** ↘
AGENT	**What** does it **look** like? ↘
ANA	It's **black** and it has a **red label.** ↘
AGENT	Are you **waiting** for a **flight**? ↗
ANA	**Yes**, my **plane** is **boarding** now! ↘
AGENT	Don't **worry**. I'm **checking** the **system.** ↘

Green bold = stressed word · ↗ voice goes up · ↘ voice goes down

PATTERN · PRONUNCIATION

Stress in compound nouns. In airport compounds, the first part is the strongest.

CHECK-in desk · BOARDing pass · SUITcase · PASSport

WATCH OUT

Common slip: boarding-PASS. Say BOARDing pass.

03

FRONT 03 · TASK-BASED LEARNING

Mission: Find the lost bag

Meaning first. Use the language you have; form comes after the task.

PROFESSOR

Ciclo: pre-task (2 min), task (8), planning (3), report (5). Durante o task não corrija: anote erros de forma (is/are, -ing) para o language focus.

OUTCOME

A short report to the airport agent that describes the bag and what is happening now.

YOUR ROLE AND THE PROBLEM

You are a passenger. Your bag is missing and your plane is boarding in 20 minutes. Work with a partner who plays the airport agent.

PRE-TASK	2 min	Read the prompts and the useful language below.
TASK	8 min	Passenger: explain the problem. Agent: ask questions and take notes. Then switch roles.
PLAN	3 min	Prepare 3 sentences about what is happening at the airport right now.
REPORT	5 min	Tell another pair how the problem ends.

TASK PROMPTS

#	PROMPT	YOUR NOTES
1	Say where you are and what you are doing.	
2	Describe your bag (colour, size).	
3	Say what the agent is doing.	
4	Explain why you are worried.	
5	Ask what will happen next.	
6	Thank the agent.	

USEFUL LANGUAGE

- I'm looking for my bag.
- What is he doing?
- Are they checking the system?
- My plane is boarding now!

FRONT 03 · CONTINUED

Language focus after the task

YOUR NOTES FROM THE TASK
Write 2 sentences you said or heard.

PATTERN

Present continuous. Subject + am / is / are + verb-ing. She is looking for her bag.

SUBJECT	BE	VERB-ING
I	am	looking
he / she / it	is	waiting
we / you / they	are	walking
run	is	running
smile	is	smiling

WATCH OUT · COMMON ERRORS

✗ She looking for her bag.	✓ She is looking for her bag.
✗ They is waiting.	✓ They are waiting.
✗ I am run to the gate.	✓ I am running to the gate.

Your turn: find one of these errors in your own notes and correct it.

04

FRONT 04 · RECONFIGURATION

Same meaning, new shape

Rebuild and transform language. Notice what moves.

PROFESSOR

Os alunos reordenam blocos de sentido (não palavras soltas) e depois transformam frases de 'I' para 'she'. Peça que sublinhem is/are/am em verde.

ACTIVITY A · REBUILD THE SENTENCE

Put the blocks in order to make a natural sentence.

1. *Say what you are doing now.*

   at gate 14 | I'm standing | right now.

2. *Say what the agent is doing.*

   is looking | for my luggage | The agent

3. *Ask politely for help.*

   Can you help me, | please?

4. *Say that your friend is relaxing.*

   is drinking | my friend Lena | a coffee.

ACTIVITY B · TRANSFORM

Rewrite each sentence about Ana. Start with She.

ORIGINAL	YOU WRITE…
1. I'm waiting for my bag.	
2. I'm standing at the gate.	
3. I'm not walking to the plane.	

CHECK · 5 MINUTES

Quick check of understanding

Work alone. Circle or write. Your teacher will check the answers with you.

1 **Ana _____ at gate 14.**

a) stand b) is standing c) standing

2 **Choose the correct sentence.**

a) They are walking. b) They walking. c) They is walking.

3 **Where is the stress in 'check-in desk'?**

a) CHECK-in desk b) check-IN desk

4 **Write a question: ask what the agent is doing.**

5 **Write two sentences about what is happening in your classroom now.**

I CAN…

Fill the circles: 1 = not yet · 2 = almost · 3 = yes!

say what is happening now with am / is / are + -ing.	○ ○ ○
ask for help at an airport.	○ ○ ○
say airport compounds with the right stress.	○ ○ ○

TEACHER NOTES

Language analysis, problems and answer key

LANGUAGE ANALYSIS (MFP)

MEANING	FORM	PRONUNCIATION
Present continuous descreve ações em andamento agora. Diferente do simple present, não é rotina.	Sujeito + am/is/are + verbo-ing. Negativo: am/is/are + not. Pergunta: inverter be e sujeito. Run → running.	Formas contraídas: I'm, she's. -ing fraco /ɪŋ/. Compostos: acento na 1ª parte (CHECK-in desk).

ANTICIPATED PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
Omitir o verbo be: She looking...	Gesto de 'be' no quadro; correção coletiva no language focus.
Confundir is/are com sujeito plural.	Cores: sujeito azul, be verde; treinar com cartões.
Dupla -n/-p: running, stopping.	Mostrar 3 exemplos e deixar os alunos deduzirem a regra.

ANSWER KEY

STAGE	ANSWERS
01 Input	Gist: 1 at the airport · 2 Her bag is missing. · True/false: 1 T, 2 F, 3 T, 4 F
04 Rebuild	1 I'm standing at gate 14 right now. · 2 The agent is looking for my luggage. · 3 Can you help me, please? · 4 My friend Lena is drinking a coffee.
04 Transform	1 She is waiting for her bag. · 2 She is standing at the gate. · 3 She is not walking to the plane.
05 Check	1 is standing · 2 They are walking. · 3 CHECK-in desk · 4 What is the agent doing? · 5 Open answer: check is/are + verb-ing.

READ · RATIONALE

O texto de Ana apresenta o present continuous em contexto de problema real. A missão força o aluno a descrever o que acontece agora, e a reconfiguração em blocos treina a ordem natural sem explicar regras.